FOR THE PERSON PLAYING THE INTERVIEWER

You don't need to know anything about consulting.

This binder gives you everything a real interviewer has: what to say, what information to hand over and when, what a good answer sounds like, and how to score it. Your partner does the thinking. You hold the facts and keep the clock.

What a case interview is, in 30 seconds

Consulting firms test candidates with a short business puzzle, called a **case**. You read out a client's problem, for example "a hot dog stand is losing money, why?". The candidate has to ask good questions, organize the problem, do some math out loud, and end with a clear recommendation. It's a test of **how they think**, not of business trivia.

Your job, in one line each

- **Read** the blue *Say* lines out loud, word for word if you like.
- **Answer** questions using the *If they ask* tables. Anything not on the list: "Not important for this case, make an assumption."
- **Hold back** the yellow *Give* boxes until the moment described. Never volunteer data early.
- **Tick** the *Listen for* boxes as you hear them. That is your evidence for scoring.
- **Never show** the green *Answer key*. It's for you to check the candidate's numbers.
- **Score** at the end with the rubric, then give feedback: 2 strengths, 2 things to fix.

The colors in every case

SAY

Words you read out loud.

GIVE ONLY WHEN…

Data you hand over (read it, or show this box) only when the trigger happens.

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The right numbers and what a strong answer contains.

IF THEY'RE STUCK

Hints in order. Give one, wait 30 seconds, then the next.

ADDED PARTLY ADDED mark steps, data and answers that go beyond the AUBCC casebook. A line under the step says exactly what was added.

Before you start (2 minutes)

- [ ] Pick a case you haven't read with them. Start with an **Easy** one.
- [ ] Read the case once to yourself, start to finish (about 5 minutes).
- [ ] Give the candidate paper, a pen and a calculator-free zone (no phone calculator; real interviews don't allow one).
- [ ] Sit across a table. Start a timer. Aim for 20–25 minutes per case.
- [ ] Keep a straight, friendly face. Real interviewers don't react much.

THE SIX STAGES

Every case follows the same shape

Each case script below walks you through these stages. Knowing the shape helps you notice when the candidate skips one.

1 **You read the prompt**

Read slowly. A good candidate writes it down and then repeats it back in their own words. If they don't, tick it as missed.

2 **They ask clarifying questions**

Usually 2–4 questions: about the goal, the client, the market. Answer from the *If they ask* table. More than ~6 questions is too many.

3 **They build a framework**

They'll ask for a minute or two of silence. Say "Sure, take your time." Then they explain how they'll break the problem into parts (for example "revenue" and "costs"). Compare with the Answer key.

4 **Analysis and math**

They ask for data, or estimate it themselves. You give the yellow boxes. They calculate out loud. You check against the Answer key.

5 **Insight: "so what?"**

After each number, a strong candidate says what it means for the client. If they don't, ask: "What does that mean for the client?"

6 **Recommendation**

You say the closing line. They should give the answer **first**, then 2–3 reasons, then risks and next steps. Under a minute.

Timing guide for a 25-minute case

Stage	Target	If it runs long
Prompt + questions	2–3 min	"Let's get going. What's your approach?"
Framework	2–4 min	"Which part would you look at first?"
Analysis and math	10–15 min	Give the next hint from the script.

Recommendation	1–2 min	"In one sentence: yes or no?"
Your feedback	5 min	Rubric + 2 strengths, 2 fixes.

Golden rules

1. Make them ask

Data comes out only when they ask for it, or when the script says "give if their estimate is way off". Asking for the right data is part of the test.

2. Let them estimate first

Many cases are **candidate-led**: they should make up reasonable numbers first. Only give the real number if theirs is far off (each script says what "far off" means), or if they ask directly.

3. Don't confirm too fast

When they get a number right, say "Okay, keep going." When it's wrong, say "Can you double-check that?" Never tell them the right number until they've tried twice.

4. Silence is fine

When they ask for time, give it: real interviewers wait. Only speak up after about 60 seconds of total silence.

5. Push back once

Once per case, ask "Why?" or "Are you sure?" even when they're right. It tests whether they stay calm and can defend their logic.

6. Hints in order

If they're stuck, use the red hint boxes one at a time. Every hint you give costs a point on "Drive" in the rubric. Note how many you gave.

Phrase bank

They ask for time to think	"Sure, take a minute."
They ask something not in your script	"Good question, but it's not important here. Make a reasonable assumption."
They ask "Is that right?"	"What do you think?" or "Walk me through how you got there."
They're silent for a long time	"Can you walk me through what you're thinking?"
They ramble or go off-track	"Let's focus. What do you need to answer the client's question?"

They finish a calculation and stop	"So what does that mean for the client?"
They made a math mistake	"Can you double-check that last step?"
They ask you to just give the number	"What would you estimate?" (Give it if the script says so.)
Time is running out	"The CEO just walked in. What's your recommendation?"

USE THIS FOR EVERY CASE

Scoring rubric

Score each area from 1 to 5. A 3 means "would probably pass at a first-round interview". Use the ticks from the case script as evidence. Be honest: a generous score doesn't help them.

Area	1–2: Weak	3: Pass	4–5: Strong
Structure	Jumps into numbers with no plan. Framework is a generic list or misses big pieces.	Clear framework with 2–4 parts that fit the case. Some overlap or gaps.	Framework is tailored to this client, has no overlaps or gaps, and is explained in under 2 minutes. Says which part to look at first and why.
Math	Wrong answers, messy, silent working, or needs a calculator.	Correct with maybe one slip they fix themselves. Talks through steps.	Fast, correct, clean units (per day, per year, $M). Rounds sensibly and announces each step out loud.
Business sense	Reports numbers without meaning. Misses the key insight even after hints.	Explains what numbers mean when asked. Finds the insight with one hint.	Says "so what" on their own, sanity-checks results ("that seems high because..."), spots the key insight unprompted.
Communication	Hard to follow, rambles, recommendation is vague or missing.	Clear enough. Recommendation exists but is buried or long.	Answer-first, organized ("three reasons: first..."), confident, under a minute to close.
Drive	Waits for you to lead. Needed 3+ hints.	Mostly leads. Needed 1–2 hints.	Leads the whole case, asks for the right data at the right time, suggests next steps. No hints needed.

Reading the total (out of 25)

- **21–25**: Offer-level. Move to harder cases.
- **16–20**: Solid. Fix the lowest area.
- **11–15**: Getting there. Redo this case type in a few days.

- **5–10**: Practice the basics: frameworks and mental math.

How to give feedback (5 minutes)

1. Ask them first: "How do you think that went?"
2. Share **2 things they did well**, with specific moments ("you caught that the 75–80 age group is 5 years").
3. Share **2 things to fix**, again specific ("you didn't say what the −$100 meant for the owner").
4. Read them the total score and their lowest area.

PLAIN-ENGLISH GLOSSARY

Words the candidate will use

You don't need to use these. It just helps to know what they mean when you hear them.

Framework / structure	Their plan for breaking the problem into parts.
MECE	"Mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive": parts that don't overlap and together cover everything. Interviewers love it.
Revenue	Money coming in. Usually price × quantity sold.
Costs: fixed vs. variable	Fixed costs don't change with sales (rent). Variable costs grow with each unit sold (food in each hot dog).
Profit	Revenue minus costs.
Profit margin	Profit as a % of revenue. $10 profit on $100 revenue = 10% margin.
COGS	"Cost of goods sold": what it costs to make the product itself.
Payback period	Years needed to earn back an investment. Investment ÷ yearly profit.
Breakeven	The point where revenue exactly covers costs (profit = 0).
Market sizing	Estimating how big a market is, e.g. "how much is spent on diapers per year".
Market share	The % of a market one company holds.
Market entry	A case about whether a company should start selling in a new market.
Barriers to entry	Things that make it hard to enter a market: licenses, laws, big competitors.

Cross-selling	Selling a second product to an existing customer.
Sanity check	Asking "does this number make sense?" before moving on.
Price elasticity	How much customers buy less when the price goes up.
"So what?"	What a number means for the client's decision.

PICK ONE

The cases

Start with an Easy case. Read the script once on your own before you begin. Each takes 15–25 minutes plus 5 minutes of feedback.

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing · Easy · ~20 min

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability · Easy · ~20 min

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability · Easy · ~20 min

Billionaire Banker

Market entry · Medium · ~20 min

TV Family Business

Acquisition · Medium · ~25 min

Plane Ticket Price

Pricing · Medium · ~20 min

Energy Consumption

Public sector · Hard · ~25 min

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability · Hard · ~25 min

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry · Medium · ~20 min

Hair Loss Pill

New product · Medium · ~25 min

CASE 1 OF 10

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing | Easy | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A global consumer goods company is thinking about building a diaper factory in Saudi Arabia. First the candidate estimates how big the diaper market is, then judges whether the factory is worth it.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The market is about **$2.3 billion a year**. At 10% share and 15% margin the $100M factory pays back in **about 3 years** (longer once retailer margins are counted). Recommendation: promising, worth validating.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The client (a consumer goods company weighing a factory in KSA) is added. The casebook only asks for the market size.

SAY

"Our client is a large international consumer goods company that makes baby and adult hygiene products. They don't sell in Saudi Arabia today, and they're considering building a factory there to enter the market."

"Before anything else, the CEO wants to know how big the opportunity is. How large is the diaper market in Saudi Arabia?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Do we include adult diapers?	"Yes, include elderly people."
Cloth or disposable?	"Disposable only."
Value or number of diapers?	"Value in dollars, per year."
What's the client's end goal? ADDED	"To decide whether the market is big enough to justify a local factory. We'll get to that."
Who are the competitors? ADDED	"Several international and local brands. You don't need them for the sizing."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Plays back the situation and the goal (size the market, then decide on the factory)
- [ ] Asks if adult diapers count
- [ ] Confirms dollars per year

2 Approach

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach the sizing?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Lays out the steps before using any numbers
- [ ] Splits the population by age
- [ ] Includes babies (0–3) AND elderly
- [ ] Uses % of each group using diapers, then diapers per day
- [ ] Converts to a year and multiplies by price

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Population → people per year of age → users in each relevant age group (babies 0–3, elderly) → diapers per day → per year → × price per diaper.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses diapers?"
2. "Could you split the population into groups?"
3. "Try splitting by age."

3 Population

2 min

SAY

"That sounds reasonable. Go ahead. What numbers would you use for the population?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: IF THEY ASK, OR IF THEIR POPULATION IS UNDER 25M OR OVER 45M, OR LIFE EXPECTANCY IS UNDER 70 OR OVER 85.

Exhibit 1. Population of KSA: **35 million**. Life expectancy: **80 years**. For simplicity, assume the same number of people at every age.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Divides population by life expectancy
- [ ] Rounds to a workable number (~450k)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`35M ÷ 80 ≈ 437,500 → round to ~450k per year of age`

4 Diapers per day

4–5 min

SAY

"Now get me to the number of diapers used each day."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK HOW MANY PEOPLE USE DIAPERS OR HOW MANY THEY USE.

Exhibit 2. Diaper usage by age group

Age group	0–1	1–2	2–3	75–80
% using diapers	100%	90%	80%	30%
Diapers per user per day	10	8	6	4

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Notices 75–80 is FIVE years of people (2.25M), not one
- [ ] Works group by group, out loud
- [ ] Gets ~12.6M diapers per day

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Group	People	× use	× per day	= per day
0–1	450k	100%	10	4.5M
1–2	450k	90%	8	3.2M
2–3	450k	80%	6	2.2M
75–80	2.25M	30%	4	2.7M

Total ≈ **12.6M diapers per day**.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many years of age are in the 75–80 group?"
2. "Take one age group at a time."

5 Market value

2 min

SAY

"A pack of 12 sells for about $6 in stores. What's the market worth per year?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Multiplies by 365
- [ ] Price per diaper = $0.50
- [ ] States the answer clearly: about $2.3 billion a year

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
12.6M × 365 ≈ 4.6B diapers a year
4.6B × $0.50 ≈ $2.3B a year
```

6 Sanity check ADDED

2 min

SAY

"Does that number feel right to you? What could make it too high or too low?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Babies are ~80% of volume, so baby assumptions matter most
- [ ] Even age split understates babies: KSA has a young population, so the market is likely bigger
- [ ] Elderly use may start before 75
- [ ] Prices vary between premium and discount brands

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A strong candidate challenges their own number: "KSA's population skews young, so I'm probably underestimating babies. I'd call $2.3B a conservative estimate."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Which group drives most of the volume?"
2. "Is KSA's population really spread evenly by age?"

7 The factory decision ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: 10% share, 15% margin and the $100M factory are new.

SAY

"Let's get back to the client's question. They believe they can win 10% of the market within three years, at a 15% operating margin. The factory would cost $100 million. How long would it take to pay back?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 10% share = $230M revenue
- [ ] 15% margin = ~$34.5M profit a year
- [ ] Payback ≈ 2.9 years
- [ ] Spots that $2.3B is the store price: the client sells to retailers at a lower price, so real revenue is lower and payback longer
- [ ] Notes that share builds up over time, so the first years earn less

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
10% × $2.3B = $230M revenue
× 15% = $34.5M profit a year
$100M ÷ $34.5M ≈ 2.9 years
```

The best candidates add: "Retailers keep part of the $6, maybe 25–30%, so our revenue is closer to $160–170M and payback is nearer 4 years. That's still attractive."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What revenue does 10% of the market give the client?"
2. "Payback is the investment divided by yearly profit."

8 What else to check ADDED

2–3 min

SAY

"What else would you want to know before recommending the factory?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Competitors: who leads, how loyal customers are to brands
- [ ] Distribution: pharmacies, hypermarkets, online
- [ ] Is 10% share realistic for a new entrant?
- [ ] Government incentives for local manufacturing, Saudization rules
- [ ] Demand trend: birth rate, aging population
- [ ] Option to import first, build later

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Look for organized answers, for example market / competition / operations / risks, not a random list.

9 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The CEO is walking in. You have one minute. Should they build the factory?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first (yes, with conditions)
- [ ] Reasons: ~$2.3B market, ~3–4 year payback
- [ ] Risks: the 10% share assumption, retailer margins
- [ ] Next steps: competitor analysis, distribution partners, local incentives

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

"I recommend moving ahead with the factory, subject to two checks. The KSA diaper market is about $2.3B a year, probably more given the young population. At 10% share, the $100M factory pays back in 3–4 years. Next, I'd validate that 10% share is achievable against current brands, and lock in distribution and any local manufacturing incentives."

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 2 OF 10

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability | Easy | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A hot dog stand that used to make money now loses money. The candidate compares last year with this year, finds that sales dropped because of a competitor's student deal, and that food waste rose because the owner kept ordering for the old volume.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Profit fell from **+$700 to −$100 a month**. Root cause: **5 fewer meals a day** (Frank's $5 student combo), plus **$150 more food waste** from over-ordering. Fix ordering first; compete on value, not just price.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Four years in business, a loss this month and the $700/month goal are added.

SAY

"Our client owns a single hot dog stand in Hamra, Beirut. It's been running for four years and used to be comfortably profitable. Over the last few months profits have fallen, and this month the stand actually lost money."

"The owner wants to understand what's going on and what to do about it."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What do they sell, at what price?	"One meal: a hot dog and a drink for $6. The price hasn't changed in two years."
Who are the competitors? Are they affected?	"Frank's Hot Dog, two blocks away, seems to be doing fine. Indirect competitors are Roadster Diner and other restaurants."
Has anything changed recently? ADDED	"Nothing the owner can point to. That's why they called us."
What's the goal? ADDED	"Get back to at least last year's profit, about $700 a month."
Any fixed investments?	"The stand is fully paid off. Ignore it."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Plays back: one stand, profit decline, now a loss, goal of ~$700/month
- [ ] Asks whether competitors are affected
- [ ] Asks what changed recently

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = revenue − costs
- [ ] Revenue split into price and number of meals
- [ ] Costs split into food, rent, staff, utilities, waste
- [ ] Plans to compare now vs. last year to see what changed
- [ ] Uses the competitor as a benchmark: Frank's is fine, so the problem is likely ours

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Profit tree (revenue: price × volume; costs: each line) plus a comparison with last year. Since Frank's is fine, look inside the stand first.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What is profit made of?"
2. "How would you find out what changed?"

3 Last year vs. this year PARTLY ADDED

4–5 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: This year's figures are from the casebook. The whole 'last year' column is added.

SAY

"Good. The owner shared their numbers for the same month last year and this year. What's the monthly profit in each, and what changed?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY, WITH THE QUESTION.

Exhibit 1. Monthly figures (30 days)

	Last year	This year
Meals sold per day	20	15
Price per meal	$6	$6
Food cost per meal	$2	$2
Rent	$800	$800
Chef salary	$500	$500
Utilities (gas, electricity)	$350	$400
Expired food thrown away	$50	$200

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Last year: +$700 a month
- [ ] This year: −$100 a month
- [ ] Breaks the $800 drop down: revenue −$900, food cost +$300 saved, waste −$150, utilities −$50
- [ ] Concludes the main problem is volume: 5 fewer meals a day (−25%)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Last year: 20×6×30 = $3,600 − food $1,200 − (800+500+350+50) = +$700
This year: 15×6×30 = $2,700 − food $900 − (800+500+400+200) = −$100
```

Of the $800 drop, $900 is lost revenue (partly offset by $300 less food bought). Volume is the main problem, waste is the second.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Work out last year first, line by line."
2. "Which line moved the most?"

4 Two clues ADDED

3 min

SAY

"So volume is down a quarter. Why might that be? And why do you think expired food went up?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Waste rose because the owner still buys stock for ~20 meals a day while selling 15
- [ ] Organizes reasons for lower volume: internal (quality, speed, hours, staff) vs. external (competitor, foot traffic, economy)
- [ ] Asks for data on why customers left

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The two problems are linked: fewer customers, but the same ordering habits, so more food expires. A strong candidate asks how we could learn why customers left (a survey, talking to regulars).

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If you sell fewer meals but order the same amount of food, what happens?"

5 Customer survey ADDED

3 min

SAY

"We asked 100 people at Frank's who used to eat at our stand why they switched. What do you take from this?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK WHY CUSTOMERS LEFT, OR AFTER THE PREVIOUS STEP.

Exhibit 2. "Why did you switch to Frank's?" (100 former customers)

Reason	Share
Frank's new $5 student combo (hot dog, drink and fries)	45%
Our wait time is too long at lunch	25%
Frank's has more menu choices	20%
Other	10%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Value is the main issue: Frank's offers more for less
- [ ] Wait time is fixable and costs little
- [ ] 70% of reasons are about value and service, not location or quality
- [ ] Connects to the students around Hamra and AUB

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The competitor changed, not the market: Frank's launched a better-value student offer. Our service speed adds to it.

6 Should they cut the price? ADDED

3–4 min

SAY

"The owner wants to match Frank's at $5. Food cost stays $2. Suppose they also fix the waste, back to $50 a month. How many meals a day would they need to break even at $5?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Margin per meal falls from $4 to $3
- [ ] Monthly costs to cover: 800 + 500 + 400 + 50 = $1,750
- [ ] Breakeven ≈ 583 meals a month ≈ 19–20 a day
- [ ] So it needs almost all the lost customers back just to break even: risky
- [ ] Compares with keeping $6 and fixing waste: about breakeven at today's 15 meals

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Costs to cover = $1,750 a month
Margin per meal at $5 = $3 → 1,750 ÷ 3 ≈ 583 a month ≈ 19.4 a day
At $6 (margin $4): 1,750 ÷ 4 ≈ 438 a month ≈ 14.6 a day
```

Cutting the price raises breakeven by 5 meals a day. Matching on value (a combo) is safer than cutting the price.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How much does the stand keep from each meal at $5?"
2. "Which costs stay the same whatever they sell?"

7 What should they do?

3 min

SAY

"So what would you recommend instead, or as well?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fix ordering: buy for actual demand (saves ~$150 a month right away)
- [ ] Answer Frank's on value: a combo with fries or a student deal at $6
- [ ] Cut lunch wait times: prep ahead, a helper at peak hours
- [ ] Win back students: loyalty card, social media
- [ ] Extra revenue: delivery apps, ads on the stand

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Quick win: waste. Then compete on value and speed rather than cutting price. Each extra meal a day is worth about $120 a month at $6.

8 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The owner walks up. What do you tell them?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: lost ~5 meals a day to Frank's student combo, plus over-ordering
- [ ] Action 1: order for actual demand (+$150 a month)
- [ ] Action 2: launch a value combo or student offer and speed up lunch service
- [ ] Doesn't simply cut the price, explaining why
- [ ] Next step: track daily sales and waste for a month

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 3 OF 10

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability | Easy | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An events company is offered a one-night DJ concert in Riyadh. It must make at least $10,000 to be worth their time. Full house it makes $15,800, but based on their past events it would make about $9,100, so it only works with some extra income.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Full house: **$15,800** profit. At realistic sales (VIP 70%, regular 90%): **$9,140**, just under the **$10,000** bar. Go ahead only if they add ~$1–2k of extra income (F&B, a sponsor, merch) or cut costs.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The two-week deadline is added.

SAY

"Our client is a Saudi entertainment company that organizes events. They've been offered the chance to host a one-night concert in Riyadh with a famous international DJ."

"They need to decide within two weeks. Should they do it?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What's their goal? ADDED	"They only take on events that make at least $10,000 profit."
How big is the venue?	"1,000 people: 400 VIP and 600 regular."
Where does the money come from?	"Tickets and sponsors. I have numbers when you need them."
Have they done this before? ADDED	"Yes, several events in Jeddah and Riyadh. We have data on those."
Any permits needed? ADDED	"Yes, an event license. Assume it's obtainable."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks for the profit target and finds the $10k bar
- [ ] Asks about capacity
- [ ] Asks about past events

2 Framework PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook goes straight to the calculation; the framework question is added.

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profitability: revenue (tickets by tier, sponsors, extras) – costs (fixed and per ticket)
- [ ] Demand: how many tickets will really sell
- [ ] Feasibility: license, local rules and culture, timeline
- [ ] Compares the result with the $10k bar

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What would make this concert a success for the client?"

3 Full-house revenue

3 min

SAY

"Let's start with the numbers. What revenue would the concert bring in if it sells out?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT TICKETS, PRICES OR SPONSORS.

Exhibit 1. Tickets and sponsors

	VIP	Regular
Tickets available	400	600
Price	$50	$20

Confirmed sponsor	Amount
EJ Entertainment	$3,000
Sky Events	$2,000
DJDS Events	$1,000

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] VIP $20,000 + regular $12,000
- [ ] Sponsors $6,000
- [ ] Total $38,000

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

400 × $50 = $20,000
600 × $20 = $12,000
Sponsors = $6,000
Total = $38,000

4 Full-house profit

3 min

SAY

"And the costs? What's the profit if it sells out?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT COSTS.

Exhibit 2. Costs

- DJ fee: $6,000
- Venue rent: $5,000
- Maintenance and insurance: $4,000
- Operations (security, staff, sound): $4,200
- PR affiliates' commission: $3 per ticket sold

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Separates fixed costs ($19,200) from per-ticket costs ($3,000)
- [ ] Profit = $15,800
- [ ] Compares with the $10k bar: above it

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Fixed: 6,000 + 5,000 + 4,000 + 4,200 = $19,200
Commission: $3 × 1,000 = $3,000
Profit = 38,000 − 22,200 = $15,800
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Which costs depend on tickets sold?"

5 Realistic sales ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Past sell-through (70% / 90%) and the $10k minimum are new.

SAY

"That assumes every ticket sells. Here's how the client's last three events sold. What profit should they expect?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY. (IF THEY ASKED ABOUT PAST SALES EARLIER, PRAISE THAT AND GIVE IT THEN.)

Exhibit 3. Average share of tickets sold, last three events

VIP	Regular
70%	90%

Sponsors pay the same amount regardless of attendance.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] VIP: 280 × $50 = $14,000
- [ ] Regular: 540 × $20 = $10,800
- [ ] Commission falls too: 820 × $3 = $2,460
- [ ] Expected profit ≈ $9,140
- [ ] Says clearly: below the $10,000 bar

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Revenue: 14,000 + 10,800 + 6,000 = $30,800
Costs: 19,200 + 2,460 = $21,660
Profit = $9,140, about $860 short of the bar
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many VIP tickets is 70%?"
2. "Does the commission change?"

6 Closing the gap ADDED

3 min

SAY

"How could they close that gap?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Extra income: food and drink stands, merchandise, parking, photo packages
- [ ] Another sponsor
- [ ] Sell more VIP: early-bird presale, better marketing, group deals
- [ ] Cut costs: negotiate the DJ or venue fee, the commission rate
- [ ] Prices: a small VIP price increase if demand allows

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

They need only ~$1,000 more. One food concession or one small sponsor would do it. Strong candidates size an idea, e.g. "500 people spending $5 at a food stand with a 50% margin is $1,250".

7 Beyond the numbers

2 min

SAY

"What else could go wrong with this event?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] License and regulations, timing of approval
- [ ] Cultural fit of the audience and event format
- [ ] Ticket sales timeline (two weeks to decide, months to sell)
- [ ] DJ cancellation risk: contract terms
- [ ] Safety and crowd management

8 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"So, should they do it?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: yes, but only with extra income secured
- [ ] Full house $15.8k, but realistic $9.1k is under the $10k bar
- [ ] Close the gap with a food concession or one more sponsor before signing
- [ ] Next steps: start presales early, check DJ cancellation terms

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 4 OF 10

Billionaire Banker

Market entry | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A real-estate billionaire wants to get into Saudi banking. The candidate compares opening a new bank with buying an existing one, and finds a hidden risk: the target bank lends heavily to real estate, the client's own industry.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

New bank: **~8.8 years** payback (counting 2 years to get licensed). Acquisition: **8 years**, lower risk. Hidden catch: **35% of the target's loans are real estate**, which concentrates the client's wealth instead of diversifying it. Recommend acquiring, subject to due diligence on that loan book.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The real-estate background and the $25M budget are added.

SAY

"Our client is a Saudi billionaire who made their fortune in real estate. They're considering entering the Saudi banking sector and have up to $25 million to invest."

"Should they do it, and if so, how?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Why banking? ADDED	"They want to diversify away from real estate."
What's their objective? ADDED	"A long-term business. They want their money back within 10 years and prefer to avoid big risks."
Do they have banking experience?	"No, none."
Are there regulations?	"A banking license from the central bank is required. Nothing prevents them from applying. Saudization also applies: a share of staff must be Saudi nationals."
How competitive is the market?	"I'll share some data when you're ready."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Finds out the motive (diversification) and the goal (payback within 10 years, low risk)
- [ ] Asks about regulation

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What would you want to look at?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Market attractiveness: size, growth, profitability
- [ ] Competition: concentration, barriers to entry
- [ ] Client fit: no experience, diversification goal
- [ ] Ways to enter (build vs. buy) and the financials of each

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How could the client actually get into banking?"

3 The market ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Here's an overview of the market. What does it tell you?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT THE MARKET OR COMPETITION.

Exhibit 1. Saudi retail banking (illustrative)

Indicator	Value
Sector profit growth	~6% a year
Share of deposits held by top 5 banks	75%
Fastest-growing segment	Digital banking, small-business lending
Typical new bank: time to license and launch	~2 years

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Growing and profitable market
- [ ] Concentrated: big players dominate, so it's hard to win share from scratch
- [ ] Opportunity in niches: digital, small businesses
- [ ] Notes that licensing takes time

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Attractive but concentrated: high barriers for a newcomer. That points towards buying a foothold rather than starting from zero.

4 Build or buy PARTLY ADDED

4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Investment, revenue, margin and profit are from the casebook. The 2-year launch delay, customer count and Saudization rows are added.

SAY

"The client has two options. Which one pays back faster?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Entry options

	Option 1: open a new bank	Option 2: buy an existing banl
Investment	$15M	$20M
Yearly revenue once running	$10M	n/a
Profit margin	22%	n/a
Yearly profit	n/a	$2.5M
Time before earning	2 years (license, hiring)	Immediate
Customers	None	120,000
Saudization	Must hire ~300 staff	Already compliant

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Option 1 profit = $10M × 22% = $2.2M a year
- [ ] 6.8 years of profit + 2 years before opening ≈ 8.8 years
- [ ] Option 2: $20M ÷ $2.5M = 8 years
- [ ] Notes Option 1's revenue is only a forecast

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Option 1: 15 ÷ 2.2 ≈ 6.8 years, + 2 years to launch ≈ 8.8 years
Option 2: 20 ÷ 2.5 = 8 years
```

The trap is forgetting the 2 years before the new bank earns anything.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "When does the new bank start making money?"
2. "Payback is investment divided by yearly profit."

5 The catch ADDED

3 min

SAY

"So buying looks faster and safer. Here's one more thing from the target bank's accounts. Any concerns?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Target bank loan book

Sector	Share of loans
Real estate developers and mortgages	35%
Personal loans	30%
Small businesses	20%
Other	15%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 35% real estate exposure is high
- [ ] The client wanted to diversify AWAY from real estate: this deepens the exposure
- [ ] A property downturn would hit both the client's core wealth and the bank at once
- [ ] Suggests due diligence on loan quality, or rebalancing the book after purchase

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The key insight: the acquisition fails the client's own objective unless the real-estate exposure is reduced.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Why did the client want to enter banking in the first place?"

6 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Risk appetite is the casebook's answer; the real-estate concentration condition is added.

SAY

"What's your recommendation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: enter by acquiring, with conditions
- [ ] Reasons: 8 vs ~8.8 years, existing customers, already Saudization-compliant, lower risk for a newcomer
- [ ] Condition: due diligence on the real-estate loans; a plan to reduce that share
- [ ] Next steps: valuation check, keep the management team

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 5 OF 10

TV Family Business

Acquisition | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Dubai family business wants to buy a TV channel and earn back the price within 5 years. The full ad-slot math says exactly 5 years, but not all slots sell, so it's really 7.5. The candidate explores synergies and the right price.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Theoretical revenue $9M → payback 5 years. Actual revenue **$8M** (night slots unsold) → **7.5 years**: fails the goal. Even moving the family's own ad spend in only gets to 5. Don't buy at $15M; it works at **about $10M**.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The restaurant chain, bus company and the seller's asking price framing are added.

SAY

"Our client is a family business in Dubai. They own a restaurant chain and a bus company. They're considering buying a mid-sized TV channel. The seller is asking $15 million."

"The family wants to earn back the purchase price in less than five years. Should they buy it?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How does the channel make money?	"Advertising only."
Does the family know media? ADDED	"No, but the current management team will stay."
Who are the competitors?	"Many channels, but this one has a loyal audience. Assume no barriers to buying."
Why do they want it? ADDED	"Diversification, and they think it could help their other businesses."
Is $15M negotiable? ADDED	"Possibly. Keep that in mind."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Pins down the goal: payback under 5 years
- [ ] Asks how the channel makes money
- [ ] Asks why they want it (finds the synergy angle)

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Financials: revenue, costs, payback vs. 5 years
- [ ] Market: competitors, ad market trends
- [ ] Client fit: expertise, management
- [ ] Synergies with the restaurants and buses

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Then redirect: "Management stays and there are no barriers. Let's focus on the financials."

3 Maximum ad revenue

4 min

SAY

"Let's focus on the financials. Here's how the channel runs. What's the most ad revenue it could make in a year?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 1. Channel operations

- Broadcasts 24 hours a day, **300 days** a year
- Each hour: **10 minutes of ads**, 50 minutes of shows
- Peak hours (**4 hours a day**): $250 per ad minute
- Off-peak hours (**20 hours a day**): $100 per ad minute

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Peak: 250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
- [ ] Off-peak: 100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
- [ ] Total $9M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Peak: $250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
Off-peak: $100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
Total = $9M
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Start with one hour of peak time."

4 Payback

2 min

SAY

"Running costs are $6 million a year, mostly staff. What's the payback?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit $3M
- [ ] Payback exactly 5 years: just misses 'under 5'

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`9 − 6 = $3M → 15 ÷ 3 = 5 years`

5 Reality check PARTLY ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The $8M actual revenue is from the casebook; the slot sell-through exhibit is added.

SAY

"Does that seem right to you?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY QUESTION WHETHER EVERY SLOT SELLS (OR AFTER HINT 2).

Exhibit 2. Share of ad minutes actually sold last year

Peak	Off-peak
100%	~83%

Actual ad revenue last year: **$8M**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Realizes $9M is a ceiling: not every slot sells
- [ ] Recalculates: 8 − 6 = $2M → 7.5 years
- [ ] Notes peak is sold out (room to raise peak prices) and off-peak has spare slots

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`Profit = 8 − 6 = $2M → 15 ÷ 2 = 7.5 years`

The deal fails the 5-year goal. Peak is full, so peak prices may be too low; off-peak has ~$1M of unsold slots.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is every ad minute always sold?"
2. "Is $9M what they earn, or the most they could earn?"

6 Synergies ADDED

3 min

SAY

"The family's restaurants and buses currently spend $1.2 million a year on TV ads on other channels. How does that change the picture?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] They could move ~$1M into the unsold off-peak slots
- [ ] For the family it's a saving, not new money from outside, but it still counts at group level
- [ ] Effective profit back to ~$3M → payback 5 years: still not under 5
- [ ] Questions whether off-peak slots suit restaurant ads

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Group view: $2M channel profit + ~$1M saved ad spend ≈ $3M → 5 years. Better, but still not under 5.

7 The right price ADDED

2 min

SAY

"Without counting synergies, what's the most the family should pay to hit a five-year payback?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $2M a year × 5 years = $10M
- [ ] Uses synergies as negotiating room, not as the base case

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$2M × 5 = $10M (anything below that pays back in under 5 years)`

8 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook asks how to speed up payback; the counter-offer around $10M is added.

SAY

"What do you tell the family?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: don't buy at $15M
- [ ] Reasons: real payback 7.5 years; $9M is a ceiling; synergies only get to 5
- [ ] Counter-offer around $10M, or improve profit: raise peak prices, fill off-peak, cut staff costs
- [ ] Next steps: confirm the ad market trend, the seller's flexibility on price

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 6 OF 10

Plane Ticket Price

Pricing | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An airline is launching Dubai–Paris and wants the price that makes the most profit. Higher prices mean fewer passengers. The math gives $1,750, but that leaves the plane more than half empty and above competitors' prices, which the candidate should question.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Profit-maximizing price **$1,750** → 125 passengers, ~$146k profit per flight. But only 42% of seats are filled and competitors charge $1,450–1,600, so use **fare tiers** to fill seats (e.g. +$30k from 75 discounted group seats).

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: 'New daily route' wording is added.

SAY

"Our client is a Dubai-based airline launching a new daily route from Dubai to Paris on a 300-seat aircraft."

"They want us to recommend the ticket price that maximizes profit on each flight."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

One cabin class?	"Assume a single economy cabin for now."
Who else flies the route? ADDED	"Two other airlines. I'll share their prices if they become relevant."
Revenue besides tickets?	"Bags, seat selection, onboard sales, but ignore those for now."
What are the costs?	"I'll give you the numbers shortly."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how demand responds to price
- [ ] Asks about competitors

2 Approach

2 min

SAY

"How do you want to tackle this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Higher price → fewer passengers
- [ ] Write profit as a formula of price
- [ ] Find where profit peaks
- [ ] Plans to sanity-check against competitors

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If you raise the price, what happens to the number of passengers?"

3 Demand

3–4 min

SAY

"Our market research gives us two data points. What's the relationship between price and passengers?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 1. Market research

- At **$1,000**, we'd sell **200** seats
- At **$2,000**, we'd sell **100** seats
- Assume a straight-line relationship

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Seats = −0.1 × Price + 300
- [ ] Checks it against a data point

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Slope: −100 seats per +$1,000 = −0.1
Seats = −0.1 × P + 300 (check: P = 1,000 → 200 ✓)
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many seats do you lose for every $1,000 increase?"
2. "Try seats = a × price + b."

4 Best price

5 min

SAY

"Each flight costs $10,000 in fixed costs, plus $500 per passenger. What price maximizes profit?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = $-0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$
- [ ] Finds the peak: derivative = 0, the vertex, or testing a few prices
- [ ] $1,750 → 125 passengers → profit ≈ $146k

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Revenue = P(−0.1P + 300) = −0.1P² + 300P
Costs = 10,000 + 500(−0.1P + 300) = 160,000 − 50P
Profit = −0.1P² + 350P − 160,000 → peak at P = 350 ÷ 0.2 = $1,750
Passengers = 125; profit = 218,750 − 72,500 = $146,250
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Write revenue using price only."
2. "Profit rises then falls. Where's the top? You could test a few prices."

5 Sanity check ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Competitor fares are new.

SAY

"Here's what the two competitors charge. Does $1,750 still make sense?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Competitor fares, Dubai–Paris economy

Airline	Average fare	Flights per day
Competitor A	$1,450	3
Competitor B	$1,600	2

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] We'd be the most expensive with the fewest flights: risky
- [ ] Questions whether the research demand curve holds once customers compare prices
- [ ] Only 125 of 300 seats filled (42%), very low for an airline
- [ ] Suggests validating demand, or a reason to pay more (service, schedule)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The math is right but the result is fragile. A strong candidate doesn't just defend the formula.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How full is the plane at $1,750?"

6 The empty seats ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The tour-operator offer is new.

SAY

"175 seats fly empty. Could they make money from them without lowering the main fare? For example, a tour operator offers to buy 75 seats at $900 each, on flights it picks itself. What's that worth per flight?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 75 × ($900 − $500) = $30,000 more profit
- [ ] Main risk: full-fare customers switching to cheap seats; manage with restrictions (no refunds, fixed dates, booked early)
- [ ] Other ideas: fare tiers, last-minute deals, cargo, ancillary fees

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`75 × (900 − 500) = $30,000 per flight`

This is how airlines really price: several fare classes with restrictions, not one price.

7 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the airline?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: a $1,750 headline fare, plus restricted discount fares to fill seats
- [ ] Reasons: maximizes single-fare profit (~$146k), the discount tier adds ~$30k
- [ ] Risks: priced above competitors, low load
- [ ] Next steps: test demand, design fare rules to prevent cannibalization

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 7 OF 10

Energy Consumption

Public sector | Hard | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Gulf energy ministry wants a 10% cut in national energy use within five years. The candidate uses data to find the biggest lever (home air conditioning), sizes one initiative, and designs a program that is politically realistic.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Homes use 40% of energy; air conditioning is 70% of that. One AC upgrade program saves only **~2.5%**, so they need **a package**: efficiency standards, gradual tiered pricing, building codes, transport measures.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The 10% target, 5% growth and subsidies are added.

SAY

"The Ministry of Energy of a Gulf country wants to cut national energy consumption by 10% within five years. Consumption has grown about 5% a year, much faster than the population, and the government spends heavily subsidizing electricity and fuel."

"They've hired us to design the program. How would you approach it?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Is 10% against today's level? ADDED	"Yes, 10% below today's consumption within five years."
How cheap is energy today? ADDED	"Electricity and fuel are heavily subsidized, among the cheapest in the world."
Any constraints? ADDED	"Sharp price increases are politically sensitive."
Do we have data by sector? ADDED	"Yes. Ask when you need it."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Pins down the target (10% in 5 years)
- [ ] Spots that subsidies drive overuse
- [ ] Asks about political constraints

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"How would you structure the program?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Where energy is used: homes, businesses, industry, transport
- [ ] Levers: price, efficiency/technology, regulation, behavior
- [ ] Feasibility and politics
- [ ] Costs and benefits (incl. subsidy savings, CO_2)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Then say: "Let's start by finding where the energy goes."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses energy in a country?"

3 Where the energy goes ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Both exhibits are new.

SAY

"Here's the breakdown. Where would you focus first?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK FOR DATA ON CONSUMPTION.

Exhibit 1. Energy use by sector

Sector	Share
Residential	40%
Industry	30%
Transport	20%
Commercial and entertainment	10%

Exhibit 2. Residential use by purpose

Air conditioning	Appliances	Lighting	Other
70%	15%	10%	5%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Residential is the biggest sector
- [ ] Home air conditioning = 70% × 40% = 28% of national use
- [ ] Focuses there first

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Home air conditioning alone is ~28% of national consumption: the biggest single target.

4 Size one lever ADDED

3–4 min

SAY

"Suppose we get 30% of homes to switch to efficient AC units that use 30% less energy. How much would national consumption fall?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 40% × 70% × 30% × 30% ≈ 2.5%
- [ ] Says clearly: one quarter of the 10% target
- [ ] Concludes they need several levers together

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`0.40 × 0.70 × 0.30 × 0.30 = 2.52%`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What share of national energy is home AC?"

5 Homes and businesses

3 min

SAY

"What else could we do in homes and commercial buildings?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Efficiency standards for new AC units and appliances
- [ ] Building codes: insulation, window shading
- [ ] Smart thermostats, occupancy sensors
- [ ] Shared district cooling for new developments
- [ ] Awareness campaigns, smart meters showing usage

6 Industry and transport

3 min

SAY

"And industry and transport?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Industry: efficiency audits, incentives for efficient equipment, higher prices for heavy users
- [ ] Transport: fuel efficiency standards, public transport, car-pooling, EV charging, reducing fuel subsidies over time

7 The politics ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Raising prices would be the fastest lever, but it's politically sensitive. How would you handle that?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Gradual increases over several years
- [ ] Tiered pricing: a cheap first block, higher prices for heavy users
- [ ] Cash support for low-income households
- [ ] Use the subsidy savings to fund efficient-equipment rebates
- [ ] Clear public communication

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A strong answer protects ordinary households while making heavy users pay more.

8 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The minister has one minute. What's your program?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: a package of measures, not one lever
- [ ] Priority 1: home AC (28% of use): efficiency standards and rebates
- [ ] Priority 2: gradual tiered pricing that protects low-income homes
- [ ] Priority 3: industry audits, transport measures
- [ ] Next steps: size each lever to reach 10%; pilot in one city

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 8 OF 10

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability | Hard | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A large Saudi bank lost $100M of revenue in two years while the market grew. The candidate traces it to personal loans and credit cards, finds the bank is losing customers to digital banks, and sizes a cross-selling plan that only partly fills the gap.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Category 1 fell **$550M → $450M**, driven by losing **100k customers** (mostly to digital banks). Cross-selling adds **$24M**, only a quarter of the gap, so the bank must also fix churn (digital app, faster approvals, fees).

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The $1.0B → $900M revenue totals are added.

SAY

"Our client is one of the largest retail banks in Saudi Arabia. Their revenue has fallen two years in a row, from $1.0 billion to $900 million, while the overall market grew slightly."

"The CEO wants to know why, and what to do about it."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How does the bank make money?	"Three categories: personal loans and credit cards, car loans, and house loans. I'll give you the split."
How did competitors do? ADDED	"Traditional banks are roughly stable. A few new digital banks entered two years ago."
Any regulatory changes? ADDED	"Nothing significant."
What's the CEO's goal? ADDED	"Stop the decline and get back to $1 billion."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Notes the bank shrank while the market grew, so it's losing share
- [ ] Asks about new competitors

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] External: economy, interest rates, regulation, competitors
- [ ] Internal: revenue by product, number of customers, revenue per customer (price, fees)
- [ ] Plans to find which category fell, then why

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Then say: "The market is fine. Let's look inside the bank."

3 Which category? PARTLY ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The % mix is from the casebook; the dollar totals are added.

SAY

"Here's the revenue split. Which category is driving the decline?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 1. Revenue mix

	Total	Personal loans and cards	Car loans	House loans
2 years ago	$1.0B	55%	28%	17%
Now	$0.9B	50%	30%	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Converts percentages to dollars
- [ ] Personal loans and cards: $550M → $450M (−$100M)
- [ ] Car loans $280M → $270M (−$10M); house loans $170M → $180M (+$10M)
- [ ] Concludes Category 1 explains the entire decline

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Cat. 1: 550 → 450 = −$100M
Cat. 2: 280 → 270 = −$10M
Cat. 3: 170 → 180 = +$10M
```

The trap: car loans' share went up, but in dollars they went down.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What are those percentages in dollars?"

4 Customers or price? ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Let's dig into personal loans and cards. Is it fewer customers or less revenue per customer?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Personal loans and cards

	2 years ago	Now
Customers	600,000	500,000
Revenue per customer	~$917	$900

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Lost 100k customers (−17%)
- [ ] Revenue per customer is nearly flat (−2%)
- [ ] So it's a customer-loss problem, not a pricing problem

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The bank is losing customers. Next question: where are they going?

5 Why are they leaving? ADDED

3 min

SAY

"The bank surveyed customers who closed their accounts. Before you read it, summarize where we are for me."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: AFTER THEY SUMMARIZE.

Exhibit 3. Why former customers left

Reason	Share
Moved to a digital bank (instant approval, better app)	50%
Lower card fees elsewhere	30%
Moved abroad, other	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Gives a crisp summary: revenue −$100M, all in Category 1, driven by lost customers
- [ ] Reads the survey: digital experience is the main issue, fees second
- [ ] Links to the digital banks that entered two years ago

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Mid-case summary example: "Revenue fell $100M, all from personal loans and cards, because we lost 100k customers, mostly to digital banks."

6 Growing again

2–3 min

SAY

"Fixing the app will take time. In the meantime, how could the bank grow revenue from personal loans and cards? Is it easier to win new customers or sell more to existing ones?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Existing customers are easier and cheaper: the bank already has the relationship and data
- [ ] Cross-selling: cards to loan customers and loans to card customers
- [ ] Also: retention offers for at-risk customers

7 Size the cross-sell

5 min

SAY

"Let's size one idea: selling credit cards to customers who only have a personal loan. How much yearly revenue would it add?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 4. Cross-sell assumptions

- 500,000 customers today: **30%** have only a personal loan, **50%** only a card, **20%** both
- **10%** of loan-only customers would take a card
- Average card spending: **$20,000** a year
- **5%** of card holders default on payments
- Fees: **$250** a year per card, plus a **10%** charge on defaulters' spending

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 150k loan-only → 15,000 take a card
- [ ] Annual fees: $3.75M
- [ ] Default charges: 15,000 × 5% × $20k × 10% = $1.5M
- [ ] Total $5.25M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
15,000 × $250 = $3.75M
15,000 × 5% × 20,000 × 10% = $1.5M
Total = $5.25M a year
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many customers have only a loan?"
2. "Do the two fees one at a time."

8 Is it enough? PARTLY ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: $18.75M and $24M are from the casebook; the comparison with the $100M gap is added.

SAY

"Selling loans to card-only customers would add another $18.75 million. Is cross-selling enough to solve the CEO's problem?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Total $24M
- [ ] Only about a quarter of the $100M gap
- [ ] So the root cause, losing customers to digital banks, must be fixed too

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
3.75 + 1.5 + 18.75 = $24M, about 24% of the $100M lost
```

9 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Cross-selling is the casebook's answer; fixing churn is added.

SAY

"The CEO has two minutes. What's your recommendation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: fix churn AND cross-sell
- [ ] Facts: −$100M all in personal loans and cards; 100k customers lost, half to digital banks
- [ ] Short term: cross-sell (+$24M)
- [ ] Long term: digital app, instant approvals, review card fees
- [ ] Next steps: identify customers at risk of leaving, partnership or build options for digital

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 9 OF 10

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry | Medium | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Lebanese startup wants to launch its own cryptocurrency for payments. The candidate sizes users and profit, checks payback against a 3-year goal, then tests how much it depends on winning a large share of users.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Best case: 240k users, $61k profit a week (~$3.2M a year) → $5M back in **~1.6 years**. But that assumes they win every non-Bitcoin user. To hit 3 years they need **~126k users**, about half the available market. Recommend a pilot first.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The banking-crisis context is added.

SAY

"Our client is a Lebanese fintech startup. Since the banking crisis, many Lebanese have lost trust in banks and moved to cash and digital alternatives."

"The startup wants to launch its own cryptocurrency for everyday payments in Lebanon, and has asked us whether it's a good idea."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What does success look like? ADDED	"They want to recover their $5 million initial investment within three years."
Do they have the skills and funding?	"Yes, an experienced team and the $5M is secured."
Who are the competitors?	"Bitcoin is used by about 60% of crypto users in Lebanon. The other 40% use a mix of smaller coins we could compete for."
Is it legal? ADDED	"The central bank hasn't banned it, but there are no clear rules either."
How does the coin make money?	"Transaction fees. I'll give you details."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Pins down the goal: $5M back within 3 years
- [ ] Asks about regulation
- [ ] Asks about Bitcoin's position

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What's your framework?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Market: number of crypto users, growth, why Lebanese use crypto
- [ ] Competition: Bitcoin's 60%, switching costs
- [ ] Profitability: fees × transactions, costs, payback vs. 3 years
- [ ] Risks: regulation, trust, volatility

3 How many users?

4 min

SAY

"Let's size the opportunity. How many people could use the coin?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR CRYPTO ADOPTION.

Exhibit 1. Population ~6 million, spread evenly from age 0 to 80

Age	0–20	21–40	41–60	61–80
% using crypto	10%	25%	5%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 1.5M per age group
- [ ] 150k + 375k + 75k = 600k crypto users
- [ ] × 40% not on Bitcoin = 240k at most

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`600k crypto users × 40% = 240k potential users (a ceiling)`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many people are in each age group?"
2. "Bitcoin has 60%. What's left?"

4 Transactions

3 min

SAY

"How many transactions a week would they make?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT USAGE OR INCOME.

Exhibit 2. Usage by income

Income	% of users	Transactions per week
High	10%	7
Medium	50%	3
Low	40%	1

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 168k + 360k + 96k = 624k a week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`240k × (10%×7 + 50%×3 + 40%×1) = 240k × 2.6 = 624k a week`

5 Profit

4 min

SAY

"Here's the fee model. What's the weekly profit?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Fees

- Fixed charge: **$0.50** per transaction
- Plus a commission by size:

Transaction size	Commission	% of transactions
Up to $10k	$0.60	50%
$10k–100k	$0.40	40%
Over $100k	$0.20	10%

Profit margin: **10%**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fixed: $312k
- [ ] Average commission $0.48 → ~$300k
- [ ] Revenue ~$612k a week
- [ ] Profit ~$61k a week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$0.50 × 624k = $312k`
`$0.48 × 624k ≈ $300k`
`Revenue ≈ $612k → profit ≈ $61.2k a week`

6 Payback ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The $5M investment and 3-year goal are new.

SAY

"Does this meet the client's three-year goal?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] ~$3.2M a year (× 52)
- [ ] $5M ÷ $3.2M ≈ 1.6 years: comfortably within 3

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
61.2k × 52 ≈ $3.18M a year → 5 ÷ 3.18 ≈ 1.6 years
```

7 Stress test PARTLY ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Reasons for the 10% margin are from the casebook; the users-needed math is added.

SAY

"That assumes we win all 240,000 users. How many users do we actually need to hit the three-year goal?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit per user ≈ $3.18M ÷ 240k ≈ $13 a year
- [ ] Needs ~$1.67M a year → ~126k users
- [ ] That's over half the non-Bitcoin market: ambitious for a new coin
- [ ] Also asks: why is the margin only 10%? (servers, licensing, validation, marketing)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
$5M ÷ 3 ≈ $1.67M a year
$1.67M ÷ ~$13.3 per user ≈ 126k users (~52% of 240k)
```

8 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook's caveats are kept; the pilot and the 126k-user threshold are added.

SAY

"So, should they launch?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: yes, but with a staged pilot
- [ ] Upside: ~1.6-year payback if adoption is strong
- [ ] Risk: needs ~126k users; no clear regulation; competing with Bitcoin
- [ ] Next steps: pilot with merchants, talk to the central bank, test willingness to switch

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 10 OF 10

Hair Loss Pill

New product | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A drug company has a one-pill cure for hair loss, launching in Lebanon. The candidate sets a price, sizes how many people want and can afford it, estimates year-one revenue and profit, then judges whether it pays off.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Price ~$7,500 (1.5–2× a transplant). 1M interested → 220k can afford → 20% buy in year one → **$330M revenue**, ~**$286M profit**. Recovers a big share of the $400M R&D in year one, but the market shrinks after early adopters, so other countries matter.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: 'Just approved, first market' and the payoff question are added.

SAY

"Our client is a pharmaceutical company that has developed a pill that permanently reverses hair loss. A single pill is enough. It has just been approved in Lebanon, its first market."

"The CEO wants an estimate of first-year revenue, and a view on whether the launch will pay off."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How many pills does someone need?	"Just one."
Any competitors?	"No other pill. But hair transplants and treatments compete on price."
What do alternatives cost?	"A hair transplant costs about $5,000 on average."
What did development cost? ADDED	"We'll come back to that."
Can they make enough pills? ADDED	"Yes, capacity isn't a constraint."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how many pills are needed
- [ ] Asks about alternatives and their price
- [ ] Notes the two goals: revenue, then payoff

2 Framework

2 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue = price × buyers
- [ ] Price: value to customer, alternatives, cost
- [ ] Buyers: who has hair loss, who can afford it, how fast they adopt
- [ ] Then costs and payback for the second question

3 Price

3 min

SAY

"Let's start with price. What would you charge, and why?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Anchors on the $5,000 transplant
- [ ] One pill, permanent, no surgery: worth a premium
- [ ] Lands around $7,500–10,000
- [ ] Mentions affordability in Lebanon

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Expected range: **$7,500–$10,000** (1.5–2× a transplant). Then say: "Let's use $7,500."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What do people pay today to fix hair loss?"

4 Who wants it

4 min

SAY

"Let's use $7,500. How many people in Lebanon would be interested?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR WHO HAS HAIR LOSS.

Exhibit 1. Interest in a hair-loss treatment

Age	Men	% interested	Women	% interested
0–20	0.75M	0%	0.75M	0%
21–40	0.75M	20%	0.75M	0%
41–60	0.75M	50%	0.75M	5%
61–80	0.75M	40%	0.75M	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Includes women
- [ ] Men 825k + women 187.5k ≈ 1M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Men: 150k + 375k + 300k = 825k
Women: 37.5k + 150k = 187.5k
Total ≈ 1.01M → ~1M
```

5 Who can afford it

3 min

SAY

"Can all of them afford $7,500?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY RAISE INCOME.

Exhibit 2. Affordability by income

Income	% of people	% who can afford it
High	10%	100%
Medium	40%	30%
Low	50%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 100k + 120k = 220k

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`1M × 10% = 100k; 1M × 40% × 30% = 120k → 220k`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is $7,500 affordable for everyone in Lebanon?"

6 Year-one revenue

3 min

SAY

"Will all 220,000 buy it in the first year? What's year-one revenue?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY SAY NOT EVERYONE BUYS RIGHT AWAY.

Assume **20%** (early adopters) buy in year one.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Says only early adopters buy at first
- [ ] 44,000 × $7,500 = $330M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`220k × 20% = 44k buyers × $7,500 = $330M`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Does everyone buy a new product in its first year?"

7 Will it pay off? PARTLY ADDED

4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook raises R&D cost and price risk in words; the cost exhibit and profit math are added.

SAY

"Now the second question. Here are the costs. What's year-one profit, and will the launch pay off?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Costs

- R&D already spent: **$400M**
- Manufacturing: **$100** per pill
- Marketing and distribution: **$40M** a year
- Patent protection: 10 years

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] COGS = 44k × $100 = $4.4M
- [ ] Profit ≈ 330 − 4.4 − 40 = $285.6M
- [ ] Recovers ~70% of R&D in year one
- [ ] Notes the Lebanese market shrinks after early adopters (one pill per person, no repeat buyers)
- [ ] So payoff depends on later years and launching in other countries

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`330 − 4.4 − 40 = $285.6M year-one profit`

`Remaining Lebanese buyers: 176k → R&D likely recovered in year two`

The best insight: it's a one-time purchase, so each market dries up. International rollout is the real prize.

8 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the CEO?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: launch at ~$7,500; ~$330M revenue and ~$286M profit in year one
- [ ] R&D recovered within ~2 years
- [ ] Risks: price may be too high if results match a transplant; one-time purchase market; copycats after the patent
- [ ] Next steps: plan international rollout, test price sensitivity, financing options for middle-income buyers

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

OPTIONAL WARM-UP, 5–10 MINUTES

Fit questions

Real interviews often start with 2–3 personal questions before the case. Ask one or two. Good answers last 1–2 minutes and tell a story.

Ask	A good answer...
"Tell me about yourself."	A 1–2 minute story, not a CV list: studies, 1–2 experiences, why consulting, one personal detail that makes them memorable.
"Why consulting?"	Specific reasons tied to their own experience (problem-solving, variety, learning). Shows they know what the job really is.
"Why our firm?"	Names something specific: people they've met, a program, values. Not just "prestige".
"Give me an example of leadership."	A real situation, what THEY did and why, the result, and what they learned. Admits a shortcoming.
"What are your three biggest weaknesses?"	Real weaknesses, not humble-brags, each with what they're doing to improve.
"Tell me about a time you challenged yourself."	A clear challenge, the steps they took, the outcome.
"Why should we give you an offer?"	2–3 confident reasons linked to what consultants actually do.
"Why aren't you working in the field of your major?"	A positive story about moving toward consulting, not running away from their major.

Red flags in fit answers

- Over 2 minutes long
- Sounds memorized word for word
- Lists facts from the CV with no story
- Can't say why consulting specifically